

JOURNEY · VERTICAL BOARD · PORTRAIT ·

2026-06-19

The journey, read top to bottom.

A journey is horizontal by nature — stages left to right, mood dipping below a timeline. On a tall deck that strands it in a band. Portrait gets a board of its own: stages stack, each task is a row, and mood reads twice — the row's color and the face's position.

Mood, twice over.

The landscape board is three parallel column-grids; you can't make a stage label group its task *rows* in CSS. So portrait emits a different shape — and encodes mood redundantly so it survives a glance.

Row wash →

Mood, twice over.

Row wash — pain warm, delight cool. The emotional arc is the first thing you see.

→ next: Plotted face

Mood, twice over. (cont.)

Plotted face — seated on a pain-to-delight track with a dashed reach to the spine. The exact value, when you look closer.

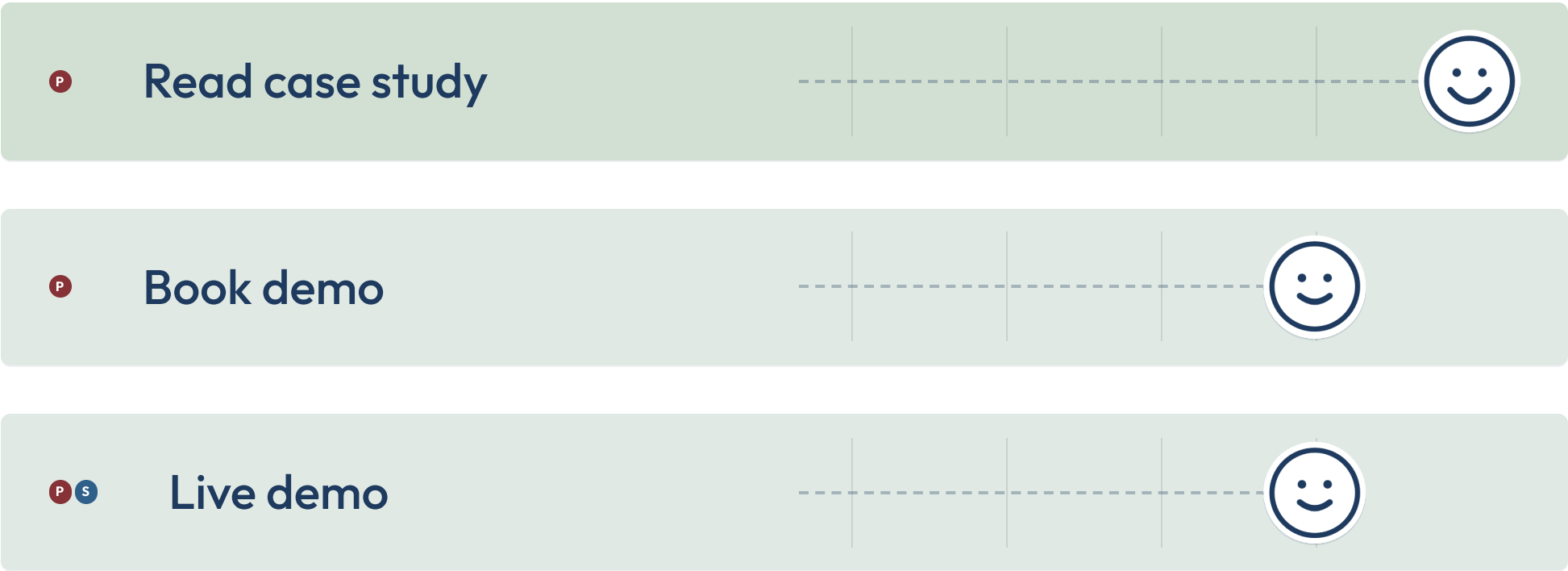
→ next: A :1 task is then unmistakable

Mood, twice over. (cont.)

A `:1` task is then unmistakable:
a pink row with the face pulled
to the edge.

Customer onboarding · trial to activation.

Evaluate



prospect sales user onboarding

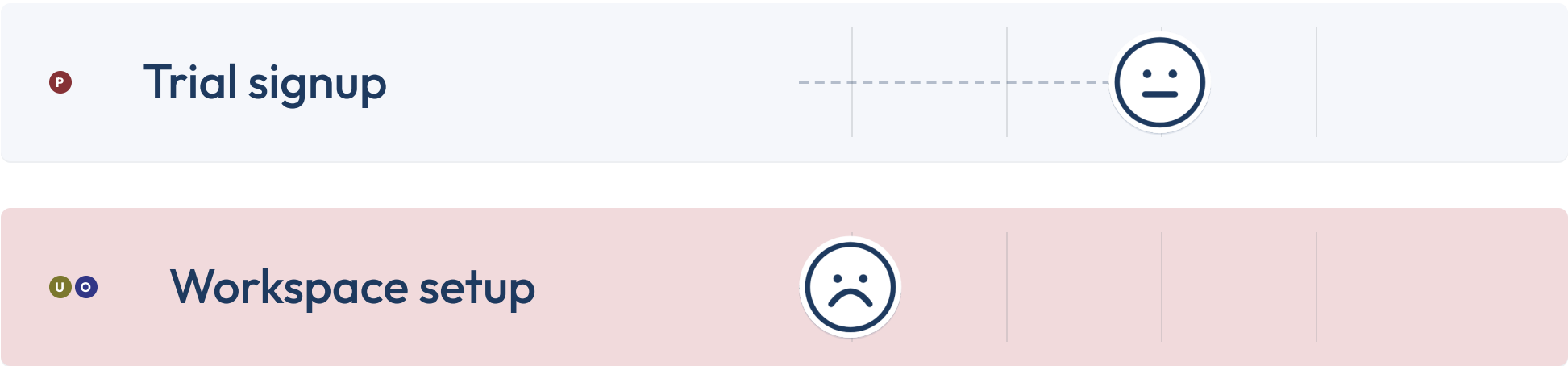
PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 DELIGHT

→ next: Trial

Customer onboarding · trial to activation.

(cont.)

Trial



P prospect S sales U user

onboarding

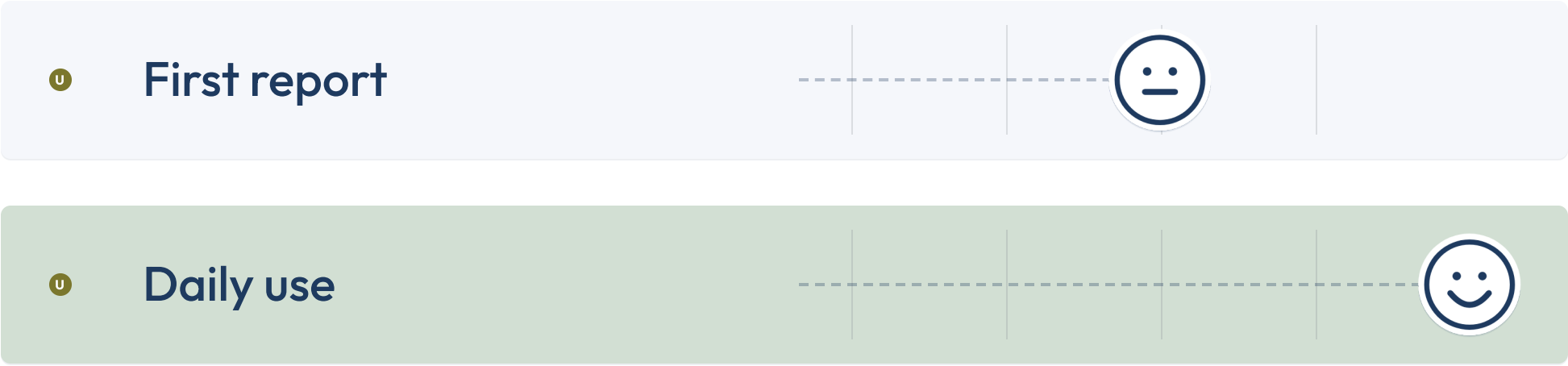
PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 DELIGHT

→ next: Activate

Customer onboarding · trial to activation.

(cont.)

Activate



prospect sales user

onboarding

PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 DELIGHT

Support ticket · first touch to resolved.

Intake

 Ticket filed



S Auto-triage



c customer

s system

A agent

E eng

PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 DELIGHT

→ next: Work

Support ticket · first touch to resolved. (cont.)

Work

^A First reply



^A Investigation



^A ^E Fix shipped



^C customer ^S system ^A agent ^E eng

PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 DELIGHT

→ next: Close

Support ticket • first touch to resolved. (cont.)

Close



Confirmation



C

customer

S

s system

A

A agent

E

E eng

PAIN

1 2 3 4 5

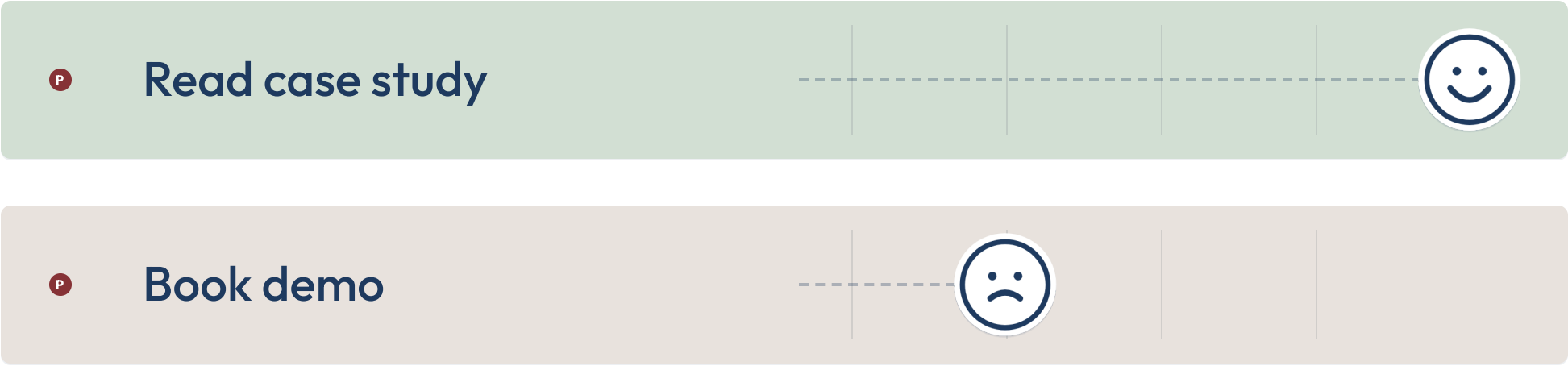
DELIGHT

A steadier arc – support resolution

4.3

Heatmap · where the trial drops off

Evaluate



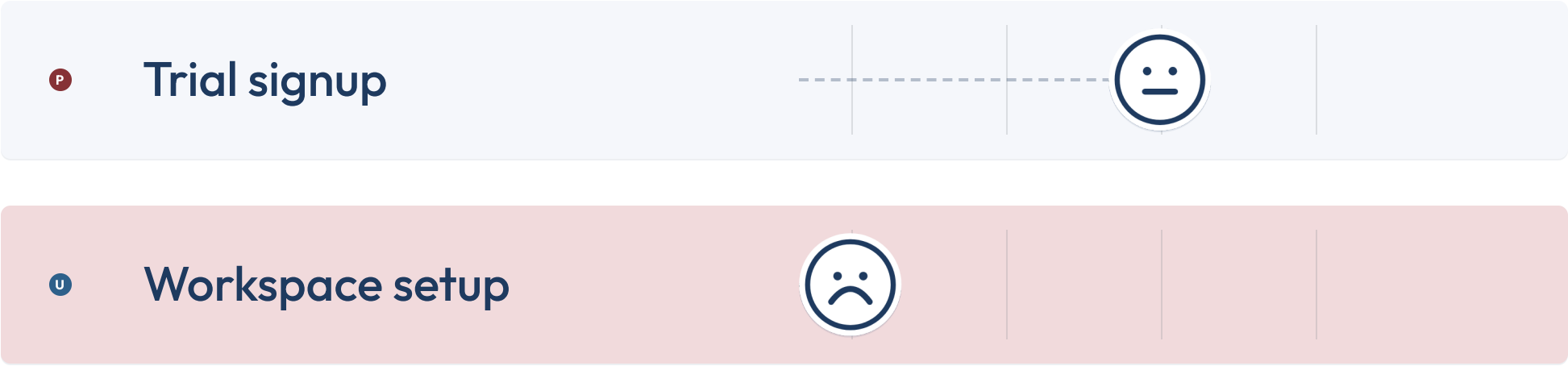
prospect user

PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 DELIGHT

→ next: Trial

Heatmap · where the trial drops off. (cont.)

Trial



P

prospect

U

user

PAIN

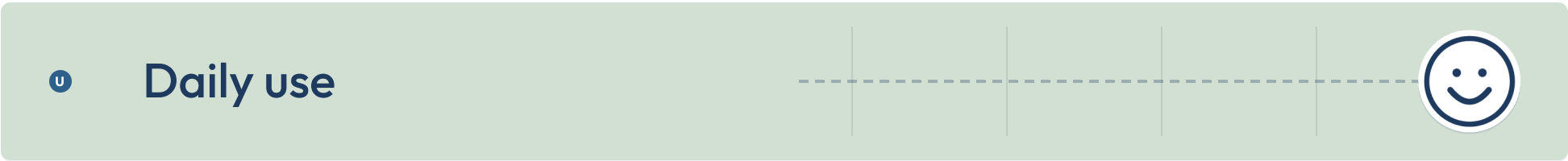
12345

DELIGHT

→ next: Activate

Heatmap · where the trial drops off. (cont.)

Activate



p prospect u user

PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 DELIGHT

A portrait deck is a different box, not a smaller slide.

The win isn't shrinking the journey to fit — it's giving the vertical canvas its own composition, where the emotional arc runs down the page and the worst moment is the one your eye lands on first.